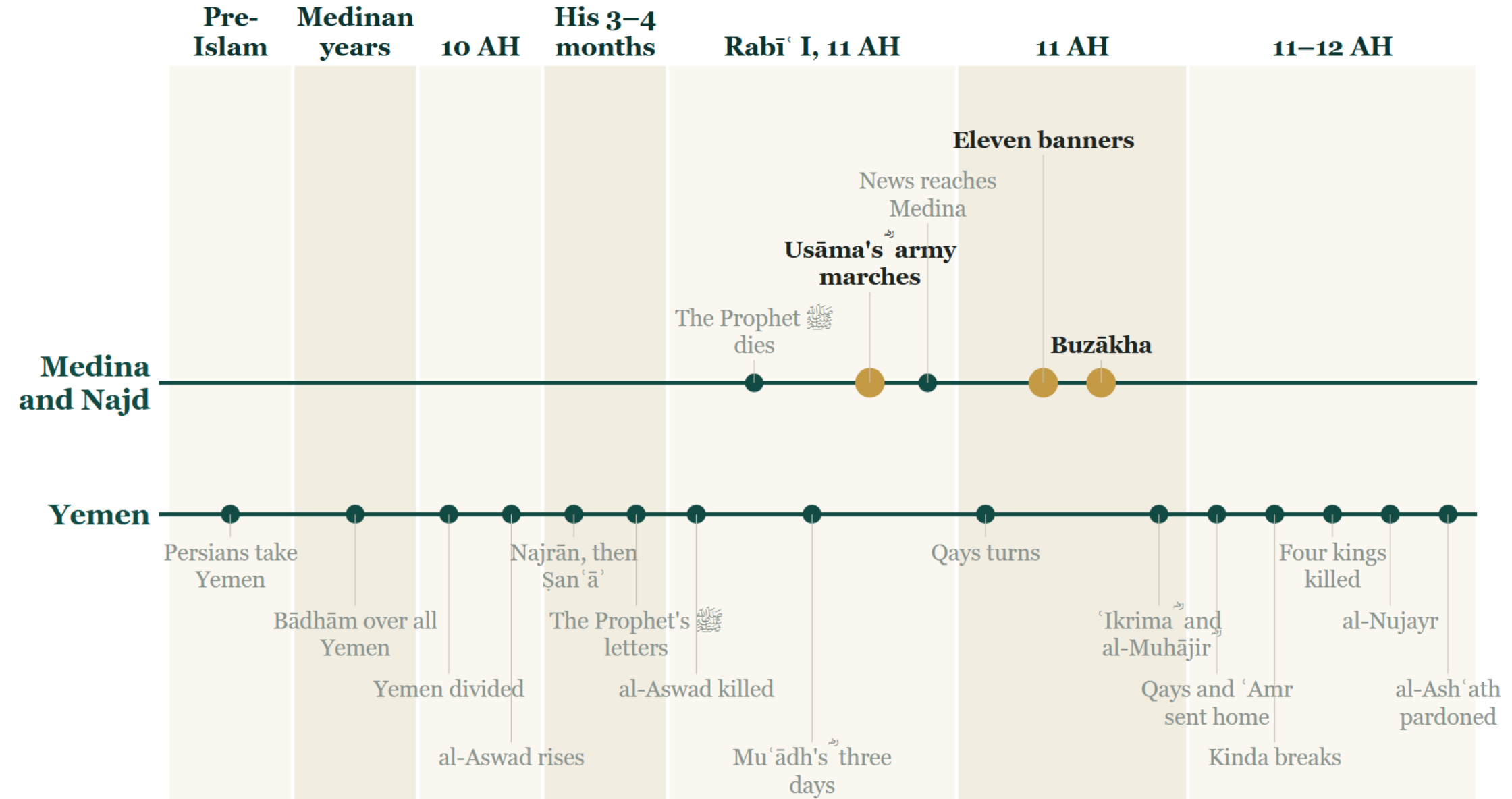


Evening 3

Yemen

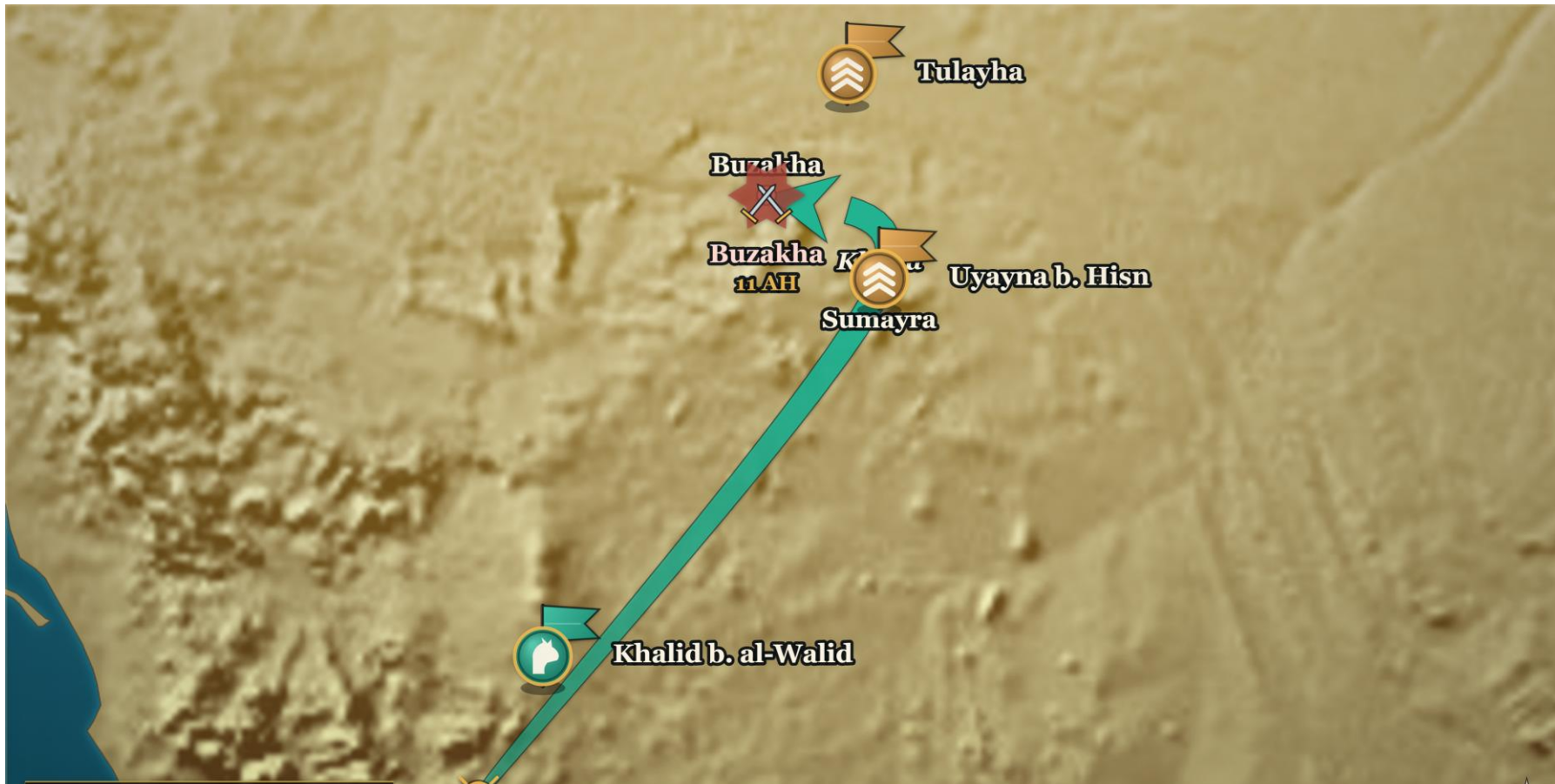
10–12 AH

Where we stopped



Buzākha, 11 AH

Buzākha
where we stopped



al-Aswad al-‘Ansī

in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

The Prophet ﷺ tells a dream

While he was asleep, he was brought the treasures of the earth.

in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

Two bracelets of gold

Two gold bracelets were placed in his hands, and they weighed heavily on him.

in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

He blows, and they are gone

He was inspired to blow on them; he blew, and they went.

in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

Two liars, named by their cities

He read them as the two liars he stood between: the man of Ṣan‘ā’ and the man of al-Yamāma.

in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

The two bracelets

بيننا أنا نائم أتيتُ بخزائن الأرض، فوَضَع في كفي سواران من ذهب، فكَبَّرَا
عليّ، فَأُوحِيَ إِلَيَّ أَنْ انْفُخْهُمَا، فَنفُخْتُهُمَا، فَذَهَبَا فَأَوَّلَتْهُمَا الْكَذَّابَيْنِ الَّذِينَ أَنَا
بينهما؛ صَاحِبَ صَنْعَاءَ، وَصَاحِبَ الْيَمَامَةِ

"...the man of Ṣan 'ā' and the man of al-Yamāma."

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 5, p. 22 (Sahih al-Bukhari 4375)

in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

Named before either had risen

The two men who would break Arabia are named together, in one sentence, before either had risen.

shortly before the Prophet's ﷺ birth

Himyar, then the Abyssinians

Before Islam Yemen was a kingdom of Himyar; their kings were called Tubba. then the Abyssinians took it, under Abraha of the Elephant.

shortly before the Prophet's ﷺ birth

A prince of Ḥimyar seeks help

Sayf b. Dhī Yazan went to Caesar and was refused; then he went to Kisrā.

shortly before the Prophet's ﷺ birth

Kisrā sends men from his prisons

Kisrā sent with him men taken out of his prisons, under a commander called Wahriz.

The Persians of Yemen



shortly before the Prophet's ﷺ birth

Ṣan'ā' taken from the Abyssinians

They broke the Abyssinians and took Ṣan'ā', a little before the birth of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.

shortly before the Prophet's ﷺ birth

The Persians of Yemen

ثم اتفق الحال على أن بَعَثَ معه ممن بالسجون طائفةً تقدمهم رجل منهم يقال
له: وهرز، فاستنقذ مُلْكَ اليمن من الحبشة

"Then it was settled that he would send with him a party of those in the prisons, led by one of them called Wahriz..."

shortly before the Prophet's ﷺ birth

The Abnā', the Sons

Those Persians stayed and married among the Arabs;
their children were called the Abnā', "the Sons".

shortly before the Prophet's ﷺ birth

Two men of the Abnā'

Fayrūz ُ and Dādhawayh, whom we meet again in Ṣan'ā',
were of the Abnā'.

The letter to Kisrā



in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

A letter to Kisrā, torn

The Prophet ﷺ wrote to Kisrā; seeing the sender's name before his own, Kisrā tore it.

in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

Kisrā's order to Bādhām

Kisrā ordered his governor in Yemen, Bādhām, to send the man to him in chains.

in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

Two officers ride to Medina

Bādhām chose two sensible officers: bring him only if his claim is false; otherwise come back and tell me.

in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

A whole month in Medina

The two officers stayed in Medina a whole month, then pressed for an answer.

in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

"My Lord has killed your lord tonight"

The Prophet ﷺ said: go back and tell your master that my Lord has killed his lord tonight.

in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

"My Lord has killed your lord tonight"

فقال لهما: ارجعا إلى صاحبيكما فأخبراه أن ربي قد قتل الليلة ربّه، فأرّخا ذلك

عندهما ثم رجعا سريعًا إلى اليمن

"He said to them: go back to your master and tell him that my Lord has killed his lord tonight. They dated it, and..."

in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

Count the night

The officers wrote down the night. Bādhām said: count it; if it is so, he is a prophet.

in the Prophet's ﷺ Medinan years

Kisrā killed that very night

Letters came from Persia: Kisrā had been killed that very night, by his own sons.

from his Islam until his death

Shīrawayh writes to Bādhām

Shīrawayh, Kisrā's son and successor, wrote: take
allegiance for me; do not dishonour that man in Arabia;
honour him.

from his Islam until his death

Islam enters Bādhām's heart

Islam entered the heart of Bādhām, of his family, and of the Persians of Yemen.

from his Islam until his death

Deputy over the whole of Yemen

Bādhām sent word of his Islam; the Prophet ﷺ made him deputy over the whole of Yemen.

from his Islam until his death

Never removed, until he died

He was not removed from it until he died. Ibn Kathīr and Ibn al-Athīr both record it.

from his Islam until his death

The whole of Yemen, until he died

وبعث إلى رسول الله ﷺ بإسلامه، فبعث إليه رسول الله ﷺ بنياية اليمن
بكمالها، فلم يعزله عنها حتى مات

*"He reported his Islam; the Messenger of Allah ﷺ sent him the
deputyship of all Yemen, and did not remove him until he died."*

from his Islam until his death

Bādhām dies; Shahr holds Ṣan‘ā’

When Bādhām died, his son Shahr was made deputy over Ṣan‘ā’ and some of its districts.

from his Islam until his death

Companions go out as deputies

Over the other districts went Companions: first, in the year ten, ‘Alī ٱ and Khālidٱ .

from his Islam until his death

Then Mu‘ādh رضي الله عنه and Abū Mūsā رضي الله عنه

After them the Prophet ﷺ sent Mu‘ādh رضي الله عنه and Abū Mūsā al-Ash‘arī رضي الله عنه .

Yemen divided, 10 AH



the year 10 AH

Four districts and their governors

Shahr kept Ṣan‘ā’; ‘Amr b. Ḥazm ٱ had Najrān; Khālīd b. Sa‘īd ٱ down to Zabīd; Abū Mūsā ٱ Ma‘rib.

the year 10 AH

And four more

Yaʿlā b. Umayya ٱ al-Janad; ʿĀmir b. Shahr Hamdān; al-
Ṭāhir b. Abī Hāla ʿAkk; Ziyād b. Labīd ٱ Ḥaḍramawt.

the year 10 AH

Mu‘ādh ^{رضي الله عنه}, a teacher on the road

Mu‘ādh b. Jabal ^{رضي الله عنه} was tied to no district: a teacher, moving from one governor's country to the next.

the year 10 AH

Yemen divided, and a teacher on the road

وَكَانَ مُعَاذُ مُعَلِّمًا يَتَنَقَّلُ فِي عَمَالَةِ كُلِّ عَامِلٍ بِالْيَمَنِ وَحَضْرَمَوْتَ.

"And Mu 'ādh was a teacher, moving through the district of every governor in Yemen and Ḥaḍramawt."

the year 10 AH

All in the year ten

All of this, Ibn Kathīr says, was in the year ten: the end of the Prophet's ﷺ life.

after Ḥajjat al-Wadā', 10 AH

‘Abhala b. Ka‘b, of ‘Ans

His name was ‘Abhala b. Ka‘b, of ‘Ans, a clan of the great tribe of Madhḥij: hence al-‘Ansī.

after Ḥajjat al-Wadā', 10 AH

Dhū al-Khimār, the veiled one

People called him the veiled one: he was never seen without a turban and a veil across his face.

after Ḥajjat al-Wadā', 10 AH

‘Abhala, "the veiled one"

وَكَانَ يُلقَّبُ ذَا الْخِمَارِ؛ لِأَنَّهُ كَانَ مُعْتَمًا مُتَخِمِّرًا أَبَدًا.

"He was nicknamed Dhū al-Khimār, because he was always turbaned and veiled."

after Ḥajjat al-Wadā', 10 AH

A conjuror with a captivating voice

The books say he was a conjuror who showed people wonders; whoever heard him speak was taken by his voice.

after Ḥajjat al-Wadā', 10 AH

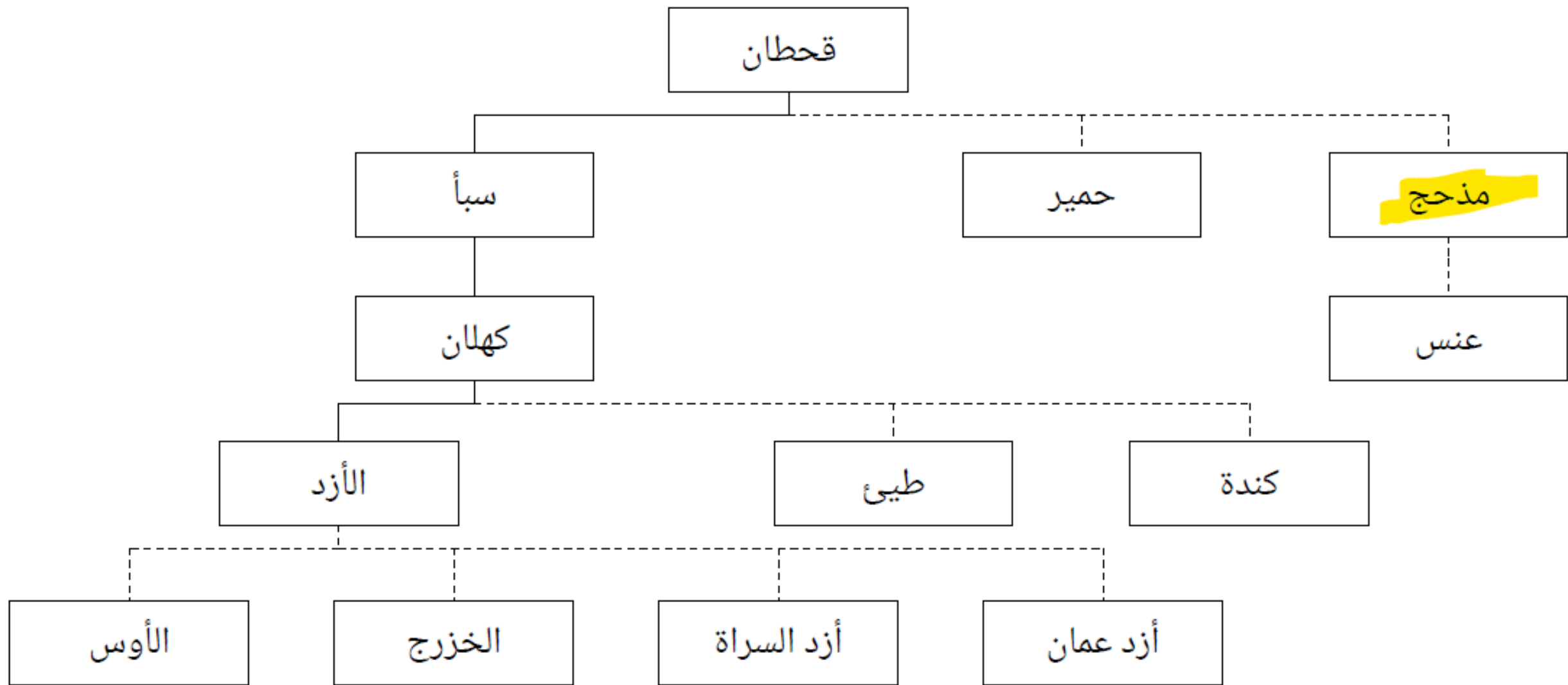
News of an illness reaches him

The Prophet ﷺ returned from the Farewell Pilgrimage ill from the journey, not his final illness; news reached 'Abhala.

after Ḥajjat al-Wadā', 10 AH

Madhḥij follows his claim

On that news he claimed prophethood, and the tribe of Madhḥij followed him.

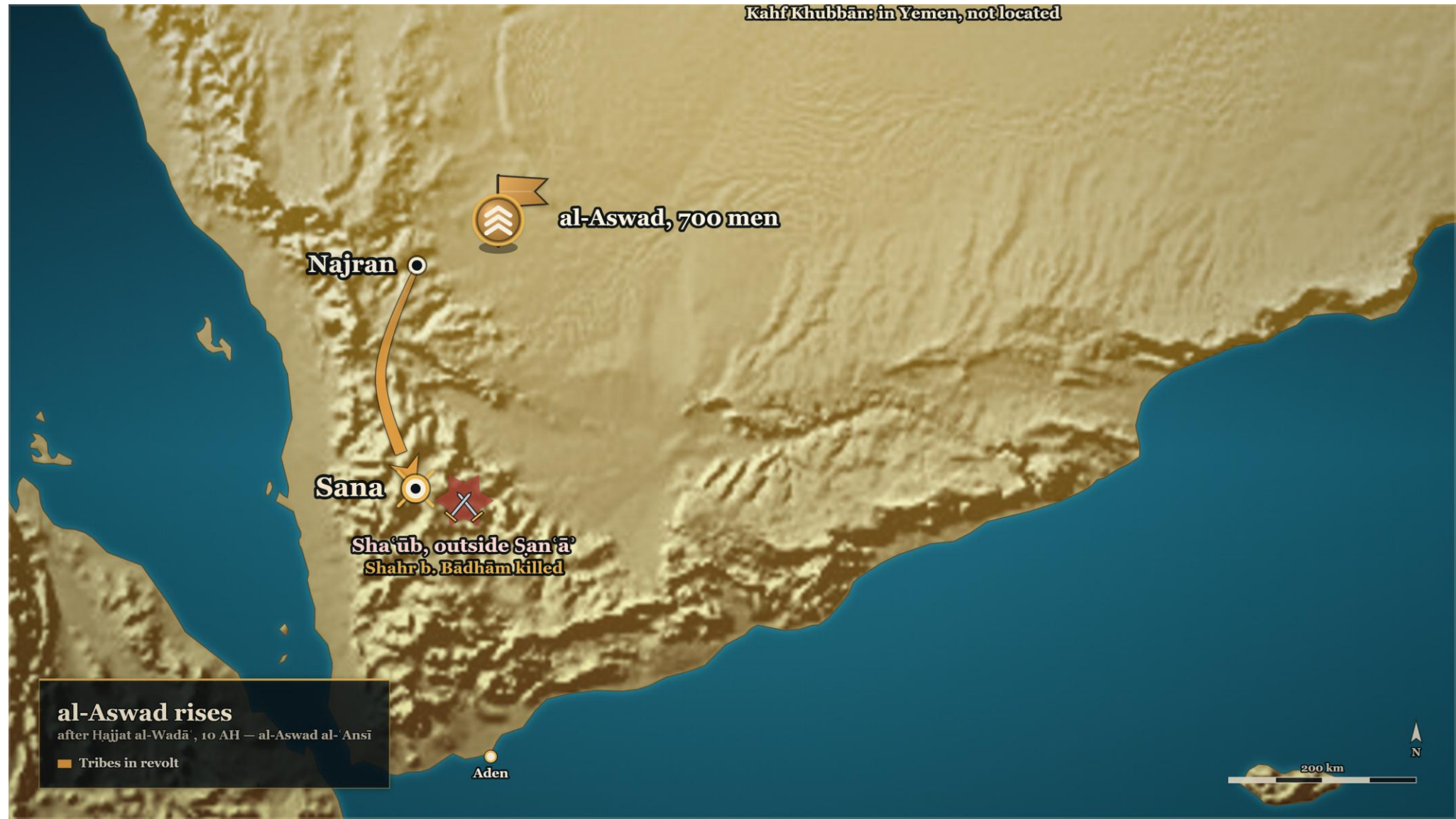


after Ḥajjat al-Wadā', 10 AH

The first apostasy in Islam

Ibn al-Athīr and al-Dhahabī both call it the first apostasy in Islam, in the Prophet's ﷺ own lifetime.

al-Aswad rises



the first nights of his rising

He comes out with seven hundred

Al-Aswad came out with seven hundred fighting men.

the first nights of his rising

"You who rebel against us"

He wrote to the Prophet's ﷺ governors, calling them rebels: hand back our land; we have the better right.

the first nights of his rising

"You who rebel against us"

وكتب إلى عُمَّال النبي ﷺ: أيُّها المتمرِّدون علينا، أمسكوا علينا ما أخذتم من
أرضنا، ووفِّروا ما جمعتم، فنحن أولى به، وأنتم على ما أنتم عليه

"He wrote to the Prophet's ﷺ governors: 'You who rebel against us — hand back what you have taken of our land, and keep...

the first nights of his rising

Najrān in ten nights

Ten nights after he came out, he had Najrān.

the first nights of his rising

The first to stand against him

Then he made for Ṣan‘ā’. Ibn al-Athīr names the first to stand against him: Shahr, Fayrūz ُ and Dādhawayh.

the first nights of his rising

Shahr killed at Sha‘ūb

Shahr son of Bādhām met him at Sha‘ūb, and was killed;
his army of the Abnā’ was broken.

the first nights of his rising

Ṣan‘ā’ within the month

Al-Aswad held Ṣan‘ā’ on the twenty-fifth night

the first nights of his rising

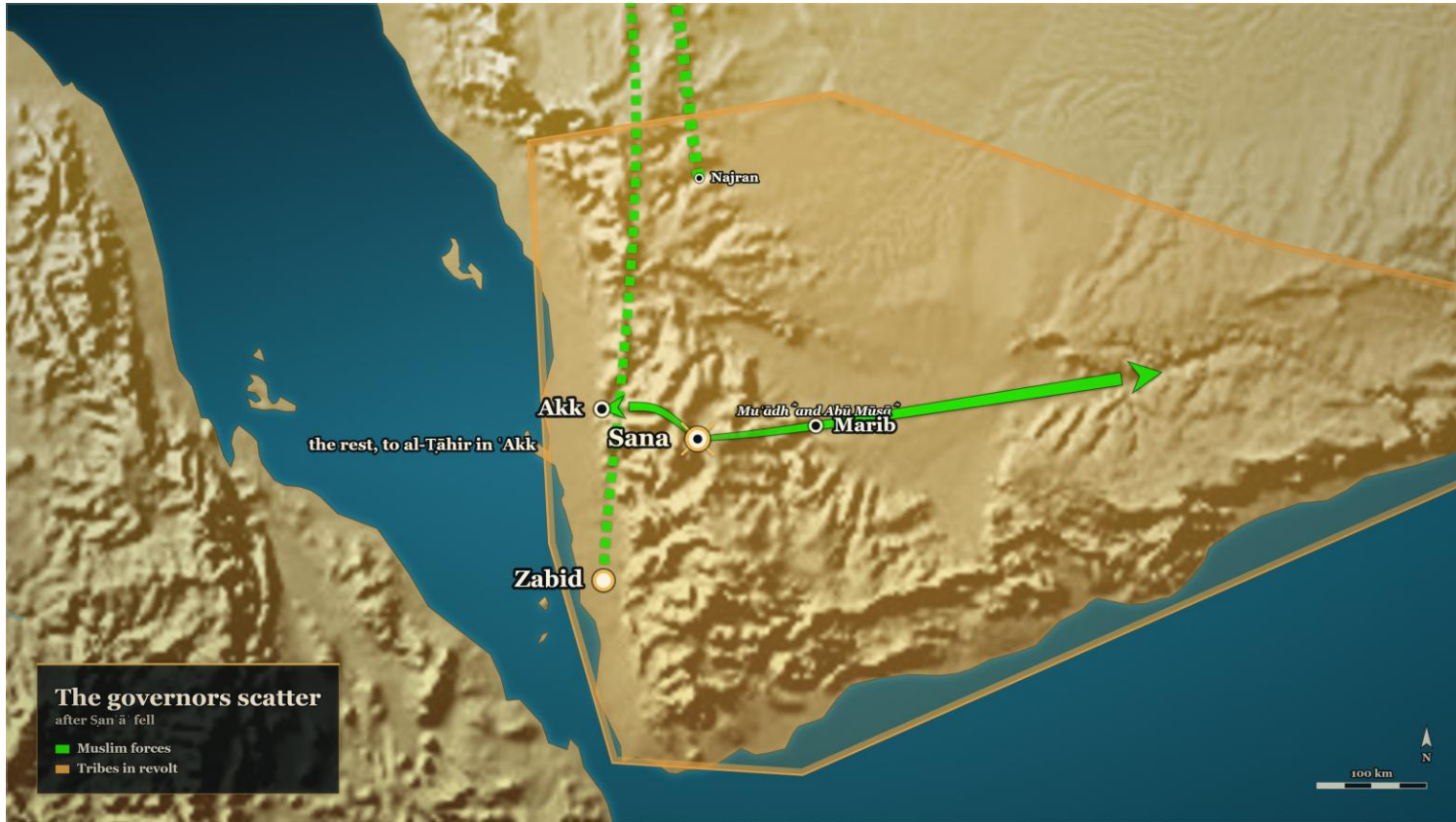
News at al-Janad, piece by piece

At al-Janad the news came in pieces: he is at Sha‘ūb;
Shahr went out; Shahr is killed; Şan‘ā’ is his.

the first nights of his rising
Spreading like fire

And the books say his affair spread like fire.

The governors scatter



Ḥaḍramawt

Mu'adh^{رضي}, Abū Mūsā^{رضي}

Medina

ʿAmr b. Ḥazm^{رضي}

after Ṣan‘ā’ fell

Mu‘ādh ؓ and Abū Mūsā ؓ to Ḥaḍramawt

Mu‘ādh ؓ left Ṣan‘ā’ in flight, reached Abū Mūsā ؓ at Ma‘rib, and the two went on to Ḥaḍramawt.

after Ṣan‘ā’ fell

The governors scatter

وَخَرَجَ مُعَاذٌ هَارِبًا حَتَّى لَحِقَ بِأَبِي مُوسَى وَهُوَ بِمَأْرِبَ، فَلَحِقَا

بِحَضْرَمَوْتَ

"Mu‘ādh went out in flight until he reached Abū Mūsā at Ma‘rib, and the two of them went on to Ḥaḍramawt."

after Ṣan‘ā’ fell

Two governors return to Medina

‘Amr b. Ḥazm ٱ and Khālīd b. Sa‘īd ٱ went back to Medina.

after Ṣan‘ā’ fell

The rest fall back on ‘Akk

The other governors fell back on al-Ṭāhir b. Abī Hāla in the mountains of ‘Akk.

after Ṣan'ā' fell

From Ḥaḍramawt to al-Ṭā'if and Aden

Ibn al-Athīr: his hand reached from the desert of Ḥaḍramawt to al-Ṭā'if, al-Aḥsā' and Aden.

after Ṣan'ā' fell

Many in Yemen apostatise

His kingdom grew strong and his affair hardened; a great many in Yemen apostatised.

after Ṣan‘ā’ fell

The Muslims who stayed hide their faith

The Muslims who stayed dealt with him by keeping their heads down and their faith hidden.

after Ṣan‘ā’ fell

He never wrote to the Prophet ﷺ

Al-Dhahabī: al-Aswad never wrote to the Prophet ﷺ; no one contested him, and Yemen was clear for him.

after Ṣan‘ā’ fell

Mu‘ādh ء married into al-Sakūn

At Ḥaḍramawt, Mu‘ādh ء married into the tribe of al-Sakūn, and they drew close around him.

during his three or four months

Madhḥij: ‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib

He had to govern what he had taken. Over Madhḥij he put ‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib.

during his three or four months

The army: Qays b. Makshūḥ

Over the army, Qays b. ‘Abd Yaghūth: the man also called Qays b. Makshūḥ.

during his three or four months

The Abnā' : Fayrūz ُ and Dādhawayh

Over the Abnā', the Persians of Ṣan'ā', two of their own:
Fayrūz al-Daylamī ُ and Dādhawayh.

during his three or four months

He marries the widow of Shahr

He married the widow of the man he had killed, Shahr son of Bādhām. She was Fayrūz's ٥ cousin.

during his three or four months

Zādh: a believer, one of the righteous

Ibn Kathīr names her Zādh: beautiful, and a believer in Allah and His Messenger ﷺ, one of the righteous.

during his three or four months

His commanders, and Shahr's widow

وتزوَّج بامرأة شهر بن باذام وهي ابنة عمِّ فيروز الدَّيلمي، واسمها زاذ، وكانت
امرأةً حسناءً جميلةً، وهي مع ذلك مؤمنةٌ بالله ورسوله محمد ﷺ، ومن
الصالحات.

*"Her name was Zādh... a believer in Allah and His Messenger
Muḥammad ﷺ, and one of the righteous."*

during his three or four months

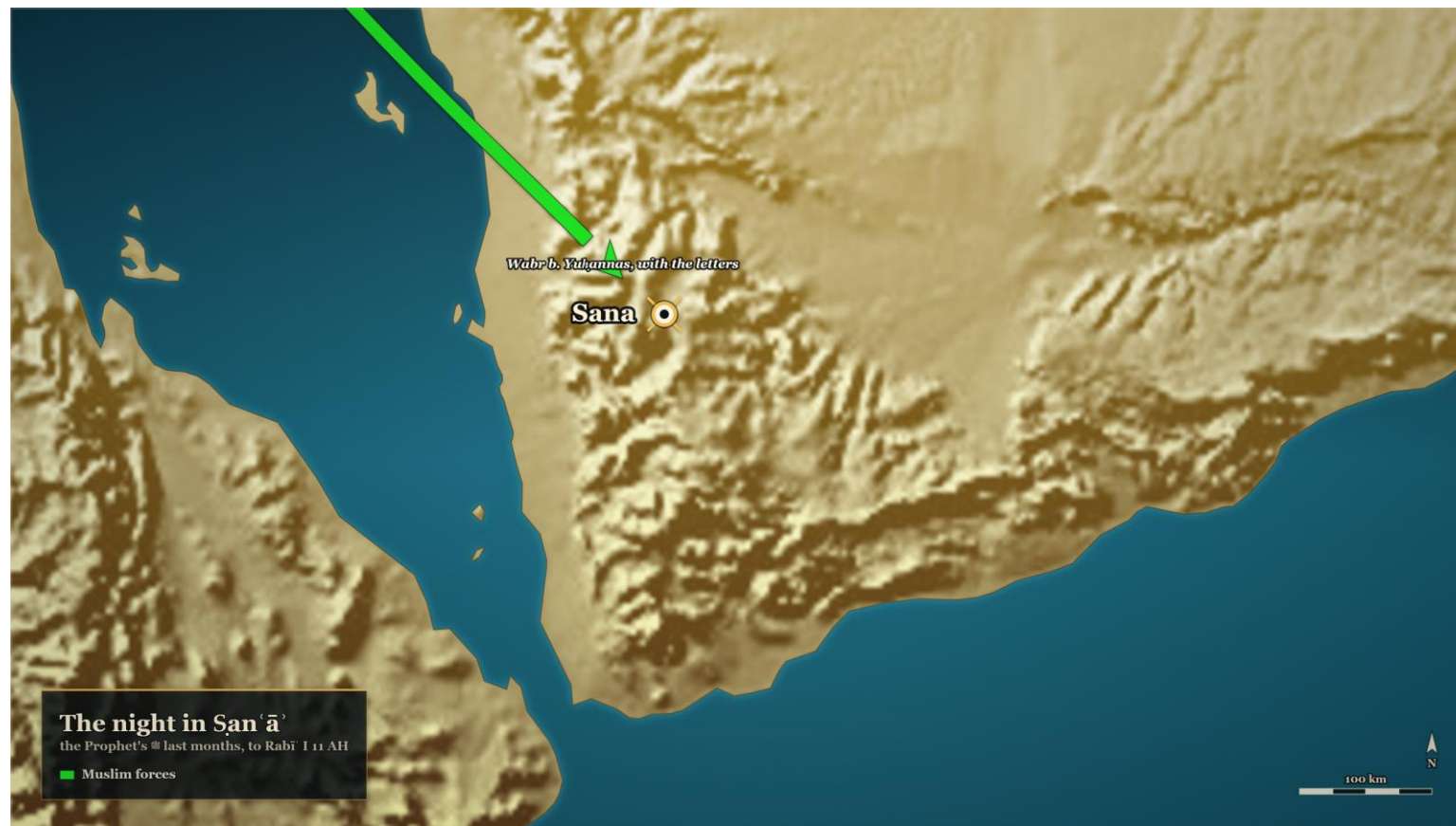
Contempt for his commanders

Once he felt secure, al-Aswad began to treat all three of his commanders with contempt.

The letters reach Ṣan‘ā’

Medina → Ṣan‘ā’

Wabr b. Yuḥannas



the Prophet's ﷺ last months

Medina hears of al-Aswad

Word of al-Aswad reached Medina, and the Prophet ﷺ wrote.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

Wabr brings the letters to Ṣan‘ā’

Wabr b. Yuḥannas brought them to Fayrūz[؁], to Dādhawayh, and to Jishnas al-Daylamī, who later told the story.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

By open fight, or by stealth

The order: fight al-Aswad, in the open or by stealth, and write to all who still held to religion.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

"By open fight, or by stealth"

فَجَاءَنَا كُتُبُ النَّبِيِّ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - يَأْمُرُنَا بِقِتَالِهِ، إِمَّا مُصَادِمَةً أَوْ
غِيْلَةً

"The letters of the Prophet ﷺ came to us, ordering us to fight him — either in open battle or by stealth."

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

Qays will answer the first call

Jishnas says they reasoned: Qays is afraid for his life; he will answer the first call.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

As if from the sky; Qays answers

They gave Qays the Prophet's ﷺ message; it was as if they had come down to him from the sky.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

Najrān answers too

Letters went to Najrān as well, and the people of Najrān answered.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

The highland chiefs are told to wait

The chiefs of the highlands wrote offering help; the men in Ṣan‘ā’ told them to wait.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

Al-Aswad senses his ruin

Word of it reached al-Aswad, and he felt it closing: he sensed his ruin.

the Prophet's ﷺ last months

Abū Bakr ؓ would fight the same way

Ibn al-Athīr: after the Prophet ﷺ, Abū Bakr ؓ fought the apostates the same way, with envoys.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

Al-Aswad summons Qays

Al-Aswad told Qays his angle, (his shayṭān), as the books call it, had said: Qays now reaches for your kingdom.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

Qays swears, and lies

Qays swore he would never think such a thing

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

"Now you have repented"

Al-Aswad accepted the oath.

Al-Aswad said: the angel spoke the truth, and now it knows you have repented

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

He calls in the other three

Did I not raise you over your people? What is this I hear?
They said: pardon us this once.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

Out barely alive

They came out, Qays says, barely alive: al-Aswad still suspicious of them, and they in danger.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

Qays comes in with ten men

Called in again, Qays came with ten men around him; al-Aswad could not kill him before them.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

"I am 'Abhala'"

In al-Dhahabī's telling: is it from me that you shelter
behind men? You want to kill me!

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

Qays offers his life; al-Aswad relents

Qays offered him his life; al-Aswad softened, and let him go.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

"Do what you have to do"

Qays walked out, passed his companions without sitting down, and said: do what you have to do.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing Qays is summoned

فَرَّقَ لَهُ وَتَرَكَهُ، وَخَرَجَ قَيْسٌ فَمَرَّ بِنَا وَقَالَ: اْعْمَلُوا عَمَلَكُمْ. وَلَمْ يَقْعُدْ عِنْدَنَا.

"He softened towards him and let him be. Qays came out, passed by us, and said: 'Do what you have to do.' And he..."

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

One of them goes in to the widow

Ibn Kathīr says it was Qays; Ibn al-Athīr and al-Dhahabī say Jishnas. The reports differ.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

"He killed your husband"

Cousin, he killed your husband, pressed the killing among your family, dishonoured the women. Will you stand with us?

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing
"Or to kill him"

She asked: to do what? To put him out, he said. She said:
or to kill him.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

She says yes

He said: or to kill him. She said: yes. By Allah, Allah has made no person more hateful to me.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

"Or kill him"

قالت: على أي أمر، قلتُ إخراجَه، قالت: أو قتله، قلت: أو قتله، قالت:

نعم، والله ما خلقَ اللهُ شخصًا هو أبغضُ إليَّ منه

"She said: or to kill him. I said: or to kill him. She said: yes — by Allah..."

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

"He stops at nothing sacred"

He stands for no right of Allah, and he stops at nothing sacred.

Ṣan'ā', the days before the killing

"I will tell you how"

When you have made up your minds, tell me, and I will tell you how it can be done.

the last day before the killing

A hundred beasts behind a line

Al-Aswad had a hundred cattle and camels brought, drew a line on the ground, and stood them behind it.

the last day before the killing

Not one crossed the line

He slaughtered them untethered and unhobbled; not one crossed the line. They milled until they died.

the last day before the killing

"Nor a day more desolate"

Qays said he never saw a thing more dreadful, nor a day more desolate.

the last day before the killing

The spear shown to Fayrūz[ؐ]

Al-Aswad turned to Fayrūz[ؐ] : I had a mind to slaughter you after these beasts. He showed him the spear.

the last day before the killing

Sent to divide the meat

Fayrūz ُ talked his way out, and was sent to divide the meat among the people of Ṣan‘ā’.

the last day before the killing

A man informing on him

Hurrying back, Fayrūz ڦ found a man informing on him.

the last day before the killing

"I will kill him tomorrow"

He heard al-Aswad say: I will kill him tomorrow, and his companions.

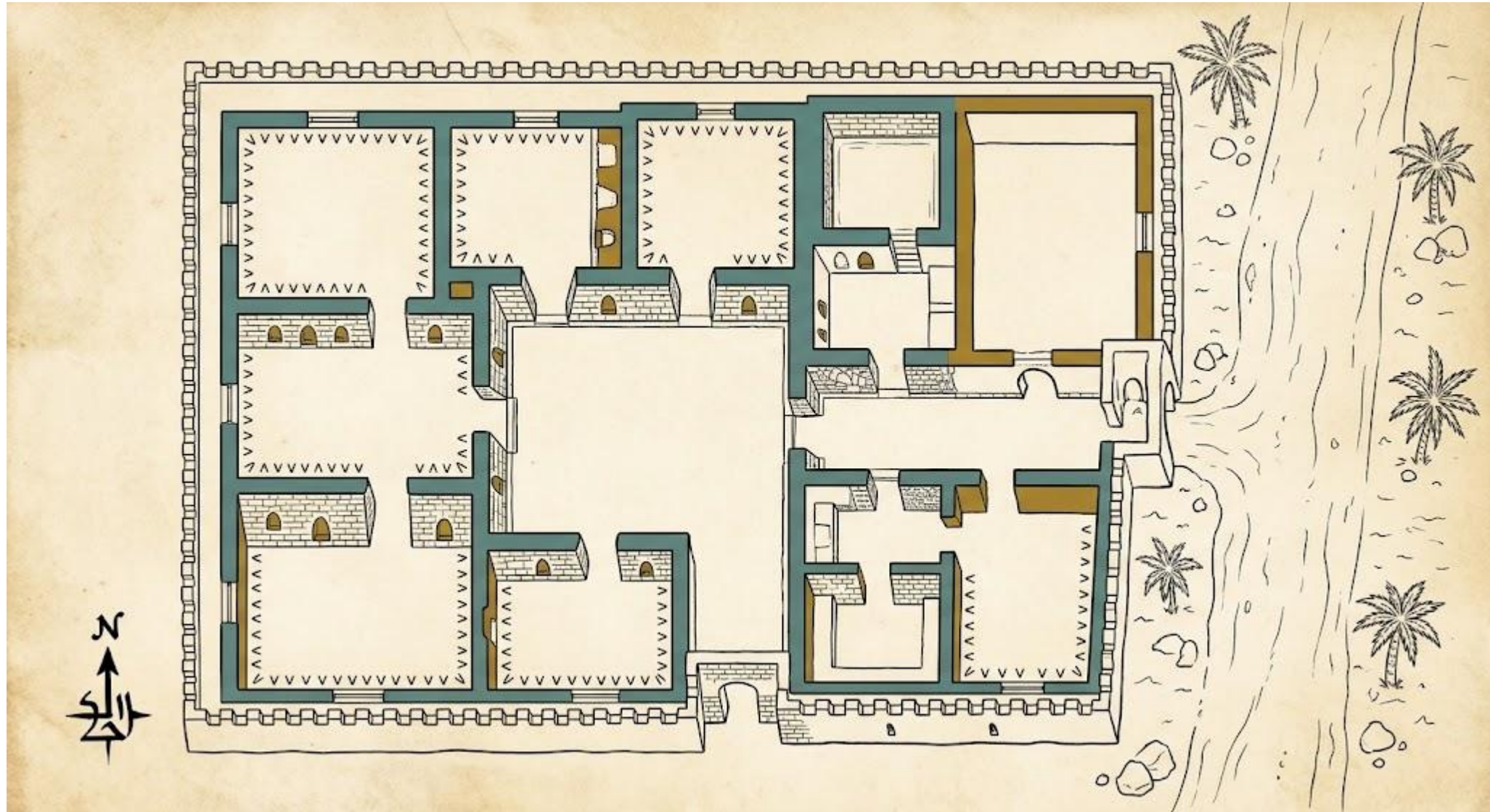
the last day before the killing

A hundred beasts, and a spear

فإذا الأسود يقول: أنا قاتله غداً وأصحابه، فاغْدُ عليَّ به

"And al-Aswad was saying: I will kill him tomorrow, and his companions — bring him to me in the morning."

The one room without a guard



the evening before the killing

The widow: every room guarded but one

Every room in this house has guards around it except this one. Its back wall is on the road.

the evening before the killing

A lamp and a weapon left ready

At evening, dig through from outside the guard. I will leave a lamp and a weapon in the room.

the evening before the killing

The one room without a guard

إنه ليس من الدار بيت إلا والحرس محيطون به، غير هذا البيت، فإن ظهره إلى
مكان كذا وكذا من الطّريق، فإذا أمسيتم فانقبوا عليه من دون الحرس

*"There is no room in the house but the guards surround it —
except this room. Its back is on such-and-such a place in...*

the evening before the killing

"What brought you in to my household?"

Al-Aswad met her visitor coming out and struck him down.

the evening before the killing

"My cousin, come to visit me"

She screamed: it is my cousin, come to visit me. He said:
be quiet; I give him to you.

the evening before the killing

"We must go, now"

The struck man ran to the others: we must go, now. They did not know what to do.

the evening before the killing

"Do not turn back"

Then a message came from her: do not turn back from what you decided.

the evening before the killing

Fayrūz ۞ loosens the wall

Fayrūz ۞ went in, loosened the wall's lining from inside to speed the digging, and sat with her openly.

the evening before the killing

"My foster-brother, and my cousin"

Al-Aswad walked in and jealousy took him. She said
Fayrūz ُ was her foster-brother and cousin; he threw him
out.

Rabī' I 11 AH

Through the wall by night

At night they dug through the wall and went in. A lamp was in the room, under a bowl.

Rabī' I 11 AH

Fayrūz ٱ goes first

Fayrūz ٱ went in first, the strongest of them.

Rabī' I 11 AH

Asleep on silk, drunk, snoring

Al-Aswad was asleep on a bed of silk, drunk and snoring;
the woman sat beside him.

Rabī' I 11 AH

His shayṭān speaks, as Ibn Kathīr tells it

Fayrūz ٱ reached the door; al-Aswad sat up, still snoring;
a voice said: what have I to do with you?

Rabī' I 11 AH

No turning back

Fayrūz ُ knew that if he turned back now, he and the woman were both dead.

Rabī' I 11 AH

Fayrūz ٱ kills him

Fayrūz ٱ threw himself on him, a man like a camel, and killed him; the others were with him.

"I have killed him, and freed you"

She caught at his clothes, thinking it not done. He said: I have killed him, and freed you of him.

Rabī' I 11 AH

The guards sent away

The others came in to finish it; the noise brought the guards. The woman answered them, and they left.

the dawn after the killing

A signal agreed for first light

They sat the rest of the night deciding how to tell their own side, and agreed a signal for dawn.

the dawn after the killing

The adhān from the fortress wall

At dawn the adhān was called from the wall.

the dawn after the killing

A new sentence in the adhān

I bear witness that Muḥammad ﷺ is the Messenger of Allah, and that ‘Abhala is a liar.

the dawn after the killing

"And that 'Abhala is a liar"

فنادى قيسٌ ويقال: وبر بن يحنس، الأذان: أشهد أن محمدًا رسول الله، وأن
عبهلة كذاب، وألقى إليهم رأسه فانهم أصحابه

*"...I bear witness that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah,
and that 'Abhala is a liar..."*

the dawn after the killing

The head thrown down

He threw al-Aswad's head down to the crowd of Muslims and unbelievers gathered below.

the dawn after the killing

The signal and the iqāma

In al-Dhahabī's telling, Dādhawayh first called out the agreed signal, and Wabr gave the iqāma for the prayer.

the dawn after the killing

His horsemen break, and raid

His horsemen broke, but first raided the town,
plundered, and snatched a great many children.

the dawn after the killing

Seventy missing: yours for ours

The people of Şan‘ā held his men in their houses;
seventy were missing. The two sides exchanged: yours for
ours.

the dawn after the killing

Riders between Ṣan‘ā’ and Najrān

His riders were left going back and forth between Ṣan‘ā’ and Najrān.

the dawn after the killing

The governors return

The Prophet's ﷺ governors came back to their districts.

the dawn after the killing

The three settle on Mu'ādhؓ

The three men competed for the command, then settled on Mu'ādh b. Jabal ؓ to lead the prayer.

the dawn after the killing

News written to the Prophet ﷺ

And they wrote the news to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.

before the Prophet's ﷺ death

The first claimant killed inside Şan‘ā’

Three men of the city killed him there, while the Prophet ﷺ was still alive.

before the Prophet's ﷺ death

The news comes that same night

It reached the Prophet ﷺ that night, from above, before any rider could carry it.

before the Prophet's ﷺ death

The Prophet ﷺ tells them

Al-‘Ansī was killed last night; a blessed man of a blessed household killed him.

before the Prophet's ﷺ death

They ask who

He named Fayrūzُ , and said the name twice.

before the Prophet's ﷺ death

"Al-‘Ansī was killed last night"

أتى الخبرُ إلى النبي ﷺ من السماء الليلة التي قُتل فيه العنسي ليبشّرنا، فقال:
قُتل العنسيُّ البارحة، قتله رجلٌ مباركٌ من أهل بيتٍ مباركين، قيل: ومن؟ قال:
فيروزُ فيروزُ.

*"The news came to the Prophet ﷺ from heaven on the night al-
‘Ansī was killed, to give us good tidings. He said: al-‘Ansī was...*

before the Prophet's ﷺ death

The killing and the news: two dates

The killing came in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime; word reached Medina later, and the reports differ on when.

Some nights before — or one night

وذلك في ربيع الأول من سنة إحدى عشرة، قبل وفاة رسول الله ﷺ بليال،
وقيل بليلة، فالله أعلم.

*"...some nights before the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ —
and it is said, one night. And Allah knows best."*

Rabī' I 11 AH

The news reaches Medina

The riders with the news reached Medina after the Prophet ﷺ had died.

Rabī' I 11 AH

Abū Bakr's ﷺ first good news

Ibn al-Athīr: it was the first good news Abū Bakr ﷺ received as caliph.

end of Rabī' I, 11 AH

The army of Usāma رضي الله عنه marches

Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه sent it out at the end of Rabī' al-Awwal.

end of Rabī' I, 11 AH

The first victory of his caliphate

Ibn Kathīr calls it the first victory of Abū Bakr's ﷺ caliphate, won while he sat in Medina.

end of Rabī' I, 11 AH

The first victory he never fought

أمضى أبو بكر جيشَ أسامةَ بن زيد في آخر ربيع الأول، وأتى مقتل الأسود في
آخر ربيع الأول بعد مخرج أسامة، فكان ذلك أولَ فَتْحٍ فَتَحَ أبو بكر وهو

بالمدينة

Abū Bakr   sent out Usāma b. Zayd's   army at the end of Rabī' al-Awwal, and news of al-Aswad's killing came at the...

Rabī' I 11 AH, Ṣan'ā'

Fayrūz ٱ tells it himself

We killed al-Aswad, he says, and our affair in Ṣan'ā' went back to what it had been.

Rabī' I 11 AH, Ṣan'ā'

They agree on Mu'ādhؓ

They sent for Mu'ādh b. Jabalؓ , agreed on him, and he led them in prayer in Ṣan'ā'.

Rabī' I 11 AH, Ṣan'ā'

Three days of prayer

By Allah, he says, Mu'ādh ؓ had led them in prayer for no more than three days.

Rabī' I 11 AH, Ṣan'ā'

The news of the death arrives

Then word reached them of the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.

Rabī' I 11 AH, Ṣan'ā'

Everything comes apart

Matters came apart, they found themselves rejecting
much of what they had known, and the earth shook.

"No more than three days"

فوالله ما صلى بنا إلا ثلاثة أيام حتى أتانا الخبر بوفاة رسول الله ﷺ

"...no more than three days before the news reached us of the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ."

after the Prophet's ﷺ death

Qays wants Yemen for himself

One of the three, Qays b. Makshūḥ, began to want the command of Yemen for himself.

after the Prophet's ﷺ death

One of the three

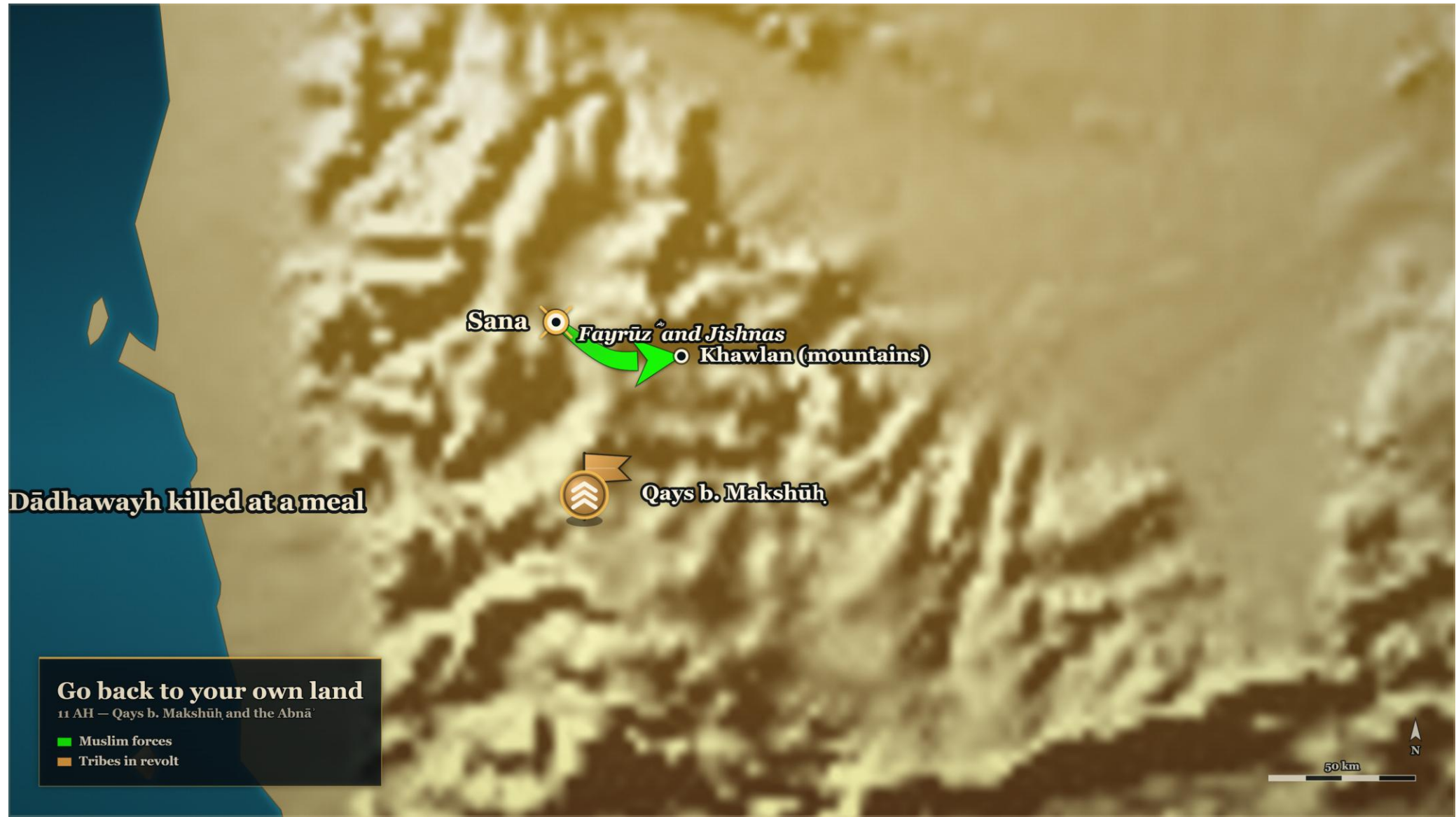
وطمَعَ قيس بن مكشوح في الإمرة باليمن، فعمل لذلك، وارتدَّ عن الإسلام

وتابعه عوامُّ أهل اليمن

"And Qays b. Makshūḥ coveted the command of Yemen, worked for it, apostatised from Islam — and the common people of Yemen followed him."

**Ṣan‘ā’ again: Qays b. Makshūḥ and
the Abnā’**

Ṣan‘ā’ again, 11 AH



after the Prophet's ﷺ death

Abū Bakr ؓ writes to five chiefs

His first move was not an army. Hold to your religion,
help the Abnā', obey Fayrūzؓ .

after the Prophet's ﷺ death

Qays writes to the same five men

Kill the Abnā', and drive their families out of the Yemen.

after the Prophet's ﷺ death

The five answer neither of them

They did not answer Qays, and they did not help the Abnā' either.

after the Prophet's ﷺ death

Qays calls in al-Aswad's scattered men

He wrote to them secretly; still drifting through the country without a leader, they came to him.

after the Prophet's ﷺ death

Qays comes asking for advice

He asked Fayrūz ر and Dādhawayh for advice about his affairs, and they were reassured.

after the Prophet's ﷺ death

Two letters to the same five men

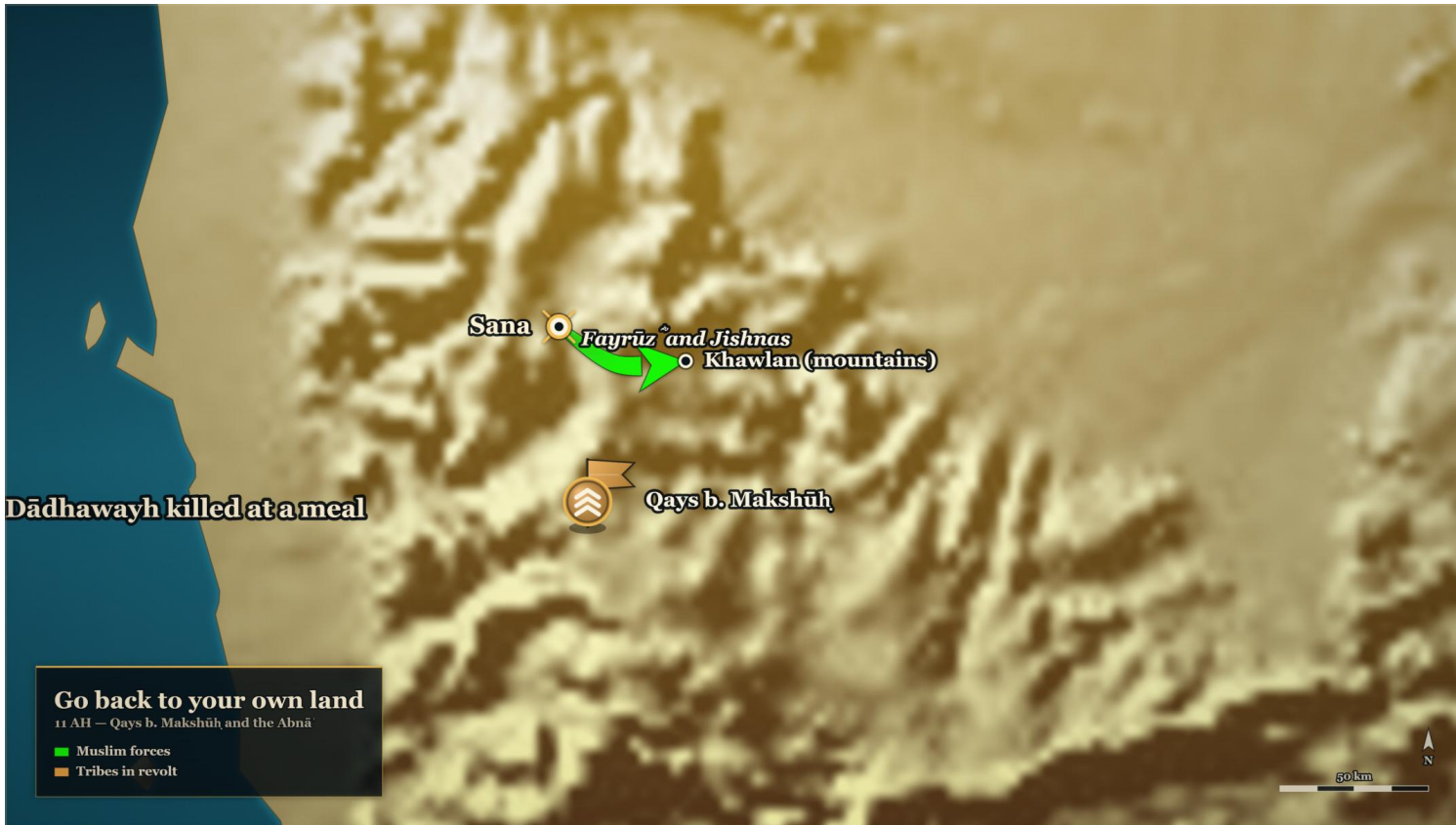
فَاسْتَشَارَهُمَا فِي أَمْرِهِ خَدِيعَةً مِنْهُ لِيُلَبِّسَ عَلَيْهِمَا، فَاطْمَأَنَّأَ إِلَيْهِ

"He consulted the two of them about his affair — a deception on his part, to confuse them — and they felt secure with...

Ṣan‘ā’ turns

Khawlān

Fayrūz



A meal, and two separate invitations

He made a meal and invited the other two men, each on his own.

11 AH, Yemen

Dādhawayh comes first

Dādhawayh arrived first, and was killed.

11 AH, Yemen

Two women talking in the street

Fayrūz al-Daylamī^{رضي}, walking to the same house, passed two women; one said he would be killed like Dādhawayh.

11 AH, Yemen

He gets out

Hearing it, Fayrūz ُ got out.

Ṣan'ā': the two women in the street

فَلَمَّا دَنَا مِنْهُ سَمِعَ امْرَأَتَيْنِ تَتَحَدَّثَانِ، فَقَالَتْ إِحْدَاهُمَا: هَذَا مَقْتُولٌ كَمَا قُتِلَ
دَاذَوَيْهِ، فَخَرَجَ.

"When he came near, he heard two women talking, and one of them said: this one will be killed just as Dādhawayh was killed..."

11 AH

Fayrūz ۞ rides out at a gallop

He had turned back in the street, and Qays's men were after him.

11 AH

Jishnas turns and rides with him

Qays had invited Jishnas too; he met Fayrūz ڤرّوز on the way and turned back with him.

11 AH

Up the mountain of Khawlān

Khawlān were Fayrūz's ُمَـوْ mother's people, and the two men climbed the mountain.

Up the mountain of Khawlān

فَطَلَبَهُ أَصْحَابُ قَيْسٍ، فَخَرَجَ يَرْكُضُ، وَلَقِيَهُ جِشْنَسُ فَرَجَعَ مَعَهُ، فَتَوَجَّهَ نَحْوَ
جَبَلِ خَوْلَانَ، وَهُمْ أَخْوَالُ فَيْرُوزَ، فَصَعِدَا الْجَبَلَ

"Qays's men went after him; he rode out at a gallop. Jishnas met him and turned back with him, and the two made for..."

11 AH

Qays's horsemen come back

They came back and told Qays.

11 AH

Qays rises in Ṣan‘ā’

He rose in the city and the country round it, and al-Aswad's old horsemen came in to him.

11 AH

Men gather to Fayrūzؑ

A body of men gathered to him, and he wrote to Abū Bakr ؑ to tell him.

11 AH

The chiefs stand aside

In the tribes Abū Bakr ﷺ had written to, the ordinary men went over to Qays.

Qays does it himself

He now did himself what he had asked the five chiefs to do: drive out the Abnā''s families.

11 AH

The Abnā' divided three ways

The families of the men who had stayed behind, he left where they were.

11 AH

Two parties of families sent away

The families of the men with Fayrūz^{رضي} : one party to Aden and the sea, one overland.

One sentence for all of them

And Qays said the same thing to all of them.

"Go back to your own land"

وَقَالَ لَهُمْ جَمِيعِهِمْ: اٰخُذُوا بِاَرْضٰكُمْ.

"And he said to all of them: Go back to your own land."

The convoys turned back



11 AH

Fayrūz ٱ gives himself to the war

When he learned what Qays had done with the families,
he threw himself wholly into the war.

11 AH

He sends to ‘Uqayl and to ‘Akk

Fayrūz ُ sent to Banū ‘Uqayl b. Rabī‘a b. ‘Āmir for help,
and to ‘Akk for help.

11 AH

‘Uqayl frees a convoy

They met Qays's horsemen escorting the families of the Abnā', freed the families, and killed the escort.

11 AH

‘Akk frees another

‘Akk went out and freed another party of the families.

11 AH

Both tribes send Fayrūz ٱ men

He went out with them, and with everyone who had gathered to him.

11 AH

The battle short of Şan‘ā’

He met Qays short of Şan‘ā’, and the fighting was hard.

11 AH

Qays is routed

Qays's side broke; al-Aswad's remaining men, Qays with them, were left wandering between Ṣan‘ā’ and Najrān.

The families brought back

فَلَقُوا قَيْسًا دُونَ صَنْعَاءَ، فَاقْتَتَلُوا قِتَالًا شَدِيدًا، وَانْهَزَمَ قَيْسٌ وَأَصْحَابُهُ، وَتَذَبَذَبَ
أَصْحَابُ الْعَنْسِيِّ وَقَيْسٌ مَعَهُمْ فِيمَا بَيْنَ صَنْعَاءَ وَنَجْرَانَ.

"They met Qays short of Ṣan 'ā' and fought hard; Qays's side was routed..."

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

He stayed behind from Tabūk

Al-Muhājir b. Abī Umayya ُ did not march to Tabūk, and the Prophet ﷺ came back displeased with him.

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

His sister was Umm Salamaؓ

She was the wife of the Prophet ﷺ.

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

One sentence, while washing his head

One day, as she washed the Prophet's ﷺ head, she spoke of her brother.

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

Why al-Muhājir ﷺ had not gone

بَيْنَمَا أُمُّ سَلَمَةَ تَغْسِلُ رَأْسَ النَّبِيِّ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - قَالَتْ: كَيْفَ
يَنْفَعُنِي عَيْشٌ وَأَنْتَ عَاتِبٌ عَلَيَّ أَخِي؟

"While Umm Salama was washing the Prophet's ﷺ head, she said: How can life be any good to me while you are displeased with...

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

She saw him soften

She signed to her servant, and her brother was called in.

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

The excuse, until he was pleased

Al-Muhājir ر kept setting out his excuse until the Prophet ﷺ was pleased, and made him governor of Kinda.

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

The Prophet ﷺ dies before he sets out

He was still in Medina, and had left Ziyād b. Labīd ؓ in charge of his post.

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه gives a double order

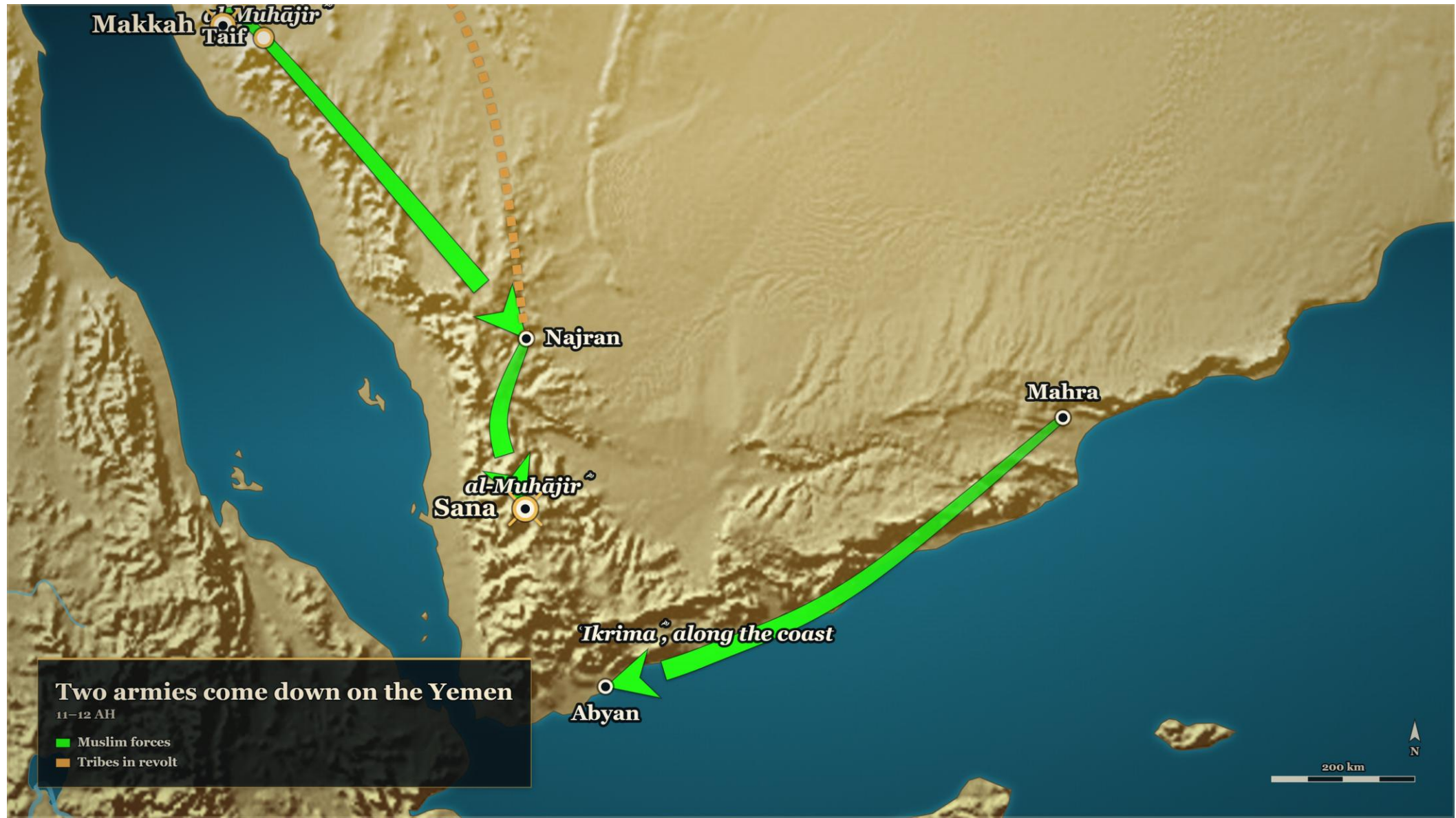
First fight those in the Yemen; then go on to the post the Prophet ﷺ gave you.

the Tabūk campaign, then 11 AH

The Yemen half of the order

Go against al-‘Ansī's troops, and help the Abnā' against Qays b. Makshūh.

Two armies come down



11 AH

‘Amr goes over to al-Aswad

‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib had been with Khālīd b. Sa‘īd^{رضي الله عنه}, and then went over to al-Aswad.

11 AH

Khālīd ٱ rides after him

He struck ʿAmr on the shoulder; ʿAmr fled, and Khālīd ٱ took his sword, al-Ṣamṣāma, and his horse.

11 AH

Two men pinned in place

Al-Aswad set 'Amr opposite the loyal Farwa b. Musayk^س ;
neither could leave his ground because of the other.

11 AH

‘Ikrima ؓ comes into Abyan

He came from Mahra with a great many men.

11 AH

Al-Muhājir ﷺ reaches Najrān

With men from Mecca and al-Ṭā'if, and Jarīr ﷺ with Bajīla; Farwa ﷺ joined him.

11 AH

‘Amr walks in without safe-conduct

He came in by himself and walked into al-Muhājir's ٢٠ camp without any safe-conduct.

Two armies come down on the Yemen

فَأَقْبَلَ عَمْرُو بْنُ مَعْدِي كَرِبَ مُسْتَجِيبًا، حَتَّى دَخَلَ عَلَى الْمُهَاجِرِ مِنْ غَيْرِ
أَمَانٍ، فَأَوْثَقَهُ الْمُهَاجِرُ

"ʿAmr b. Maʿdī Karib came in, answering the call, until he walked in on al-Muhājir without any safe-conduct — and al-Muhājir bound him."

11 AH

Both men sent to Abū Bakrؓ

Al-Muhājir ؓ bound ‘Amr, took and bound Qays as well,
and sent both to Abū Bakrؓ .

11 AH

Al-Muhājir ﷺ marches on al-Aswad's men

They asked for safe-conduct, were refused, and were killed wherever found.

11 AH

Al-Muhājir ر enters Ṣan‘ā’

He entered the city and wrote to Abū Bakr ر .

11–12 AH

Two prisoners before Abū Bakrؓ

Qays b. Makshūḥ and ‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib were brought to him in bonds.

11–12 AH

He speaks to Qays first

And he did not soften what he said.

"Qays — you killed the servants of Allah"

يَا قَيْسُ، قَتَلْتَ عِبَادَ اللَّهِ، وَاتَّخَذْتَ الْمُرْتَدِّينَ وَلِيَجَةً مِنْ دُونِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ!

"Qays — you killed the servants of Allah, and took the apostates as your confidants instead of the believers!"

11–12 AH

Qays denies it

He said he had no hand in the matter of Dādhawayh, killed after coming to his meal.

11–12 AH

What the book adds

Ibn al-Athīr adds one plain clause: he had killed him in secret.

11–12 AH

Abū Bakr ٱ lets the blood go

He let the matter of Dādhawayh's blood pass.

11–12 AH

Abū Bakr ﷺ turns to ‘Amr

Then he turned to the second prisoner, ‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib.

11–12 AH

Abū Bakr asks about shame

Was he not ashamed that every day he was either routed or taken prisoner?

11–12 AH

What this religion would have done

Had you helped this religion, Allah would have raised you.

11–12 AH

‘Amr answers in a few words

Very well: I will turn to it, and I will not go back.

"Every day routed or taken prisoner"

أَمَّا تَسْتَحِي أَنَّكَ كُلَّ يَوْمٍ مَهْزُومٌ أَوْ مَأْسُورٌ؟ ... فَقَالَ: لَا جَرَمَ، لَا أُقْبِلَنَّ وَلَا
أَعُودُ.

"Are you not ashamed to be routed or captured every day? ... He said: Surely I will turn to it, and not go back."

11–12 AH

They make their excuses

Both men excused themselves to Abū Bakrؓ .

11–12 AH

He judges only what he can see

He accepted what they professed openly, and left what was inside them to Allah.

11–12 AH

Released, and sent home

He set them free and sent them back to their own people.

11-12 AH

Abū Bakr   judges the two men

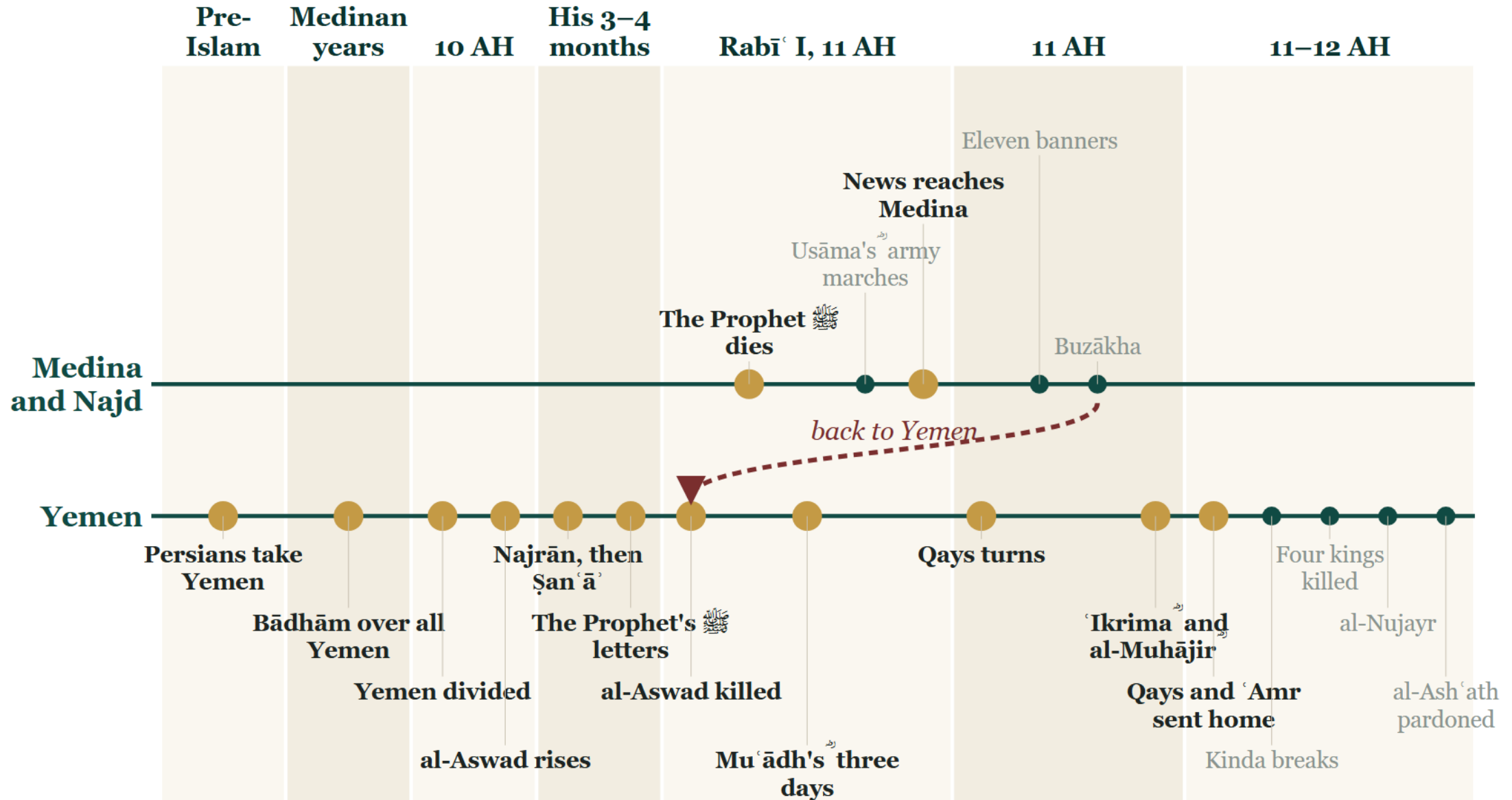
فقبل منهما علانيتهما، ووكل سرائرهما إلى الله

"...he accepted their outward profession from them, entrusted their inward states to Allah..."

The story so far

al-Aswad al-‘Ansī, and the second ridda of Ṣan‘ā’

So far tonight



**Ḥaḍramawt and Kinda: the zakāt,
al-Nujayr, and al-Ash‘ath**

Ḥaḍramawt and Kinda

IMAGE GOES HERE

MAP STUDIO, not Gemini: open tools/mapstudio/scenes/s03-07-hadramawt-and-kindajson, export step(s) 1, place here.

Ḥaḍramawt
Ziyād b. Labīd^{رضي}

Kinda
the zakāt camels

11 AH

An arrangement from the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

Part of Ḥaḍramawt's ṣadaqa went to Kinda, and part of Kinda's went to Ḥaḍramawt.

11 AH

Banū Walī'a have no camels

A clan of Kinda told Ḥaḍramawt: we have no camels to carry it; send it to us loaded.

11 AH

Ḥadramawt promises to look into it

If you really have no camels, we will send it loaded.

11 AH

After the Prophet ﷺ died

Banū Walī'a came: deliver it, the way you promised the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.

11 AH

Ḥadramawt's answer

You do have camels: carry it yourselves.

The promise about the camels

قَالَتْ بَنُو وَلِيْعَةَ: أَبْلِغُونَا كَمَا وَعَدْتُمْ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - !
فَقَالُوا: إِنَّ لَكُمْ ظَهْرًا فَاحْتَمِلُوا

"Banū Walī'a said: Deliver it to us, as you promised the Messenger of Allah ﷺ! They said: You do have mounts — carry it...

11 AH

Kinda turns on the governor

To Ziyād b. Labīd ۞ they said: you are with them against us.

11 AH

Home with nothing settled

Ḥaḍramawt would not carry it; Kinda kept insisting, and went home with the matter undecided.

11 AH

Ziyād ٱ does nothing yet

He was waiting for al-Muhājir ٱ to arrive.

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

A young she-camel is branded

Collecting the zakāt in Kinda, Ziyād b. Labīd ٱ took a young she-camel from a man and branded her.

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

She was not his to give

She belonged to his brother, her name was Shadhra, and he had brought her by mistake.

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

The brothers ask for her back

The brother said so, and the first man agreed and asked for her back.

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Ziyād ٱ refuses

She had already passed into the right of Allah, he said.

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

A third man, Ḥāritha, rides up

Release her and take another, he said. Ziyād ٱ answered that he had no way to do that.

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Ḥāritha unties her

He said one sentence, untied her hobble himself, and stood in front of her.

The she-camel called Shadhra

فَقَالَ حَارِثَةُ: ذَاكَ إِذَا كُنْتَ يَهُودِيًّا، وَأَطْلَقَ عِقَالَهَا وَبَعَثَهَا وَقَامَ دُونَهَا.

"Ḥāritha said: That would be so if you were a Jew — and he untied her hobble and drove her off and stood in...

11 AH

A warning spoken over the camel

When Ziyād ٱ refused to give her back: do not let Shadhra be for you what al-Basūs was.

11 AH

Al-‘Addā’ calls out to his clan

The camel's owner raised the cry to his own people.

The humbled man

فَنَادَى الْعَدَّاءُ: يَا آلَ عَمْرٍو، أَضَامُ وَأُضْطَهَدُ! إِنَّ الدَّلِيلَ مَنْ أَكِلَ فِي دَارِهِ!

"Al- 'Addā' called out: O family of 'Amr — am I to be wronged and trampled? The humbled man is the one who is devoured..."

11 AH

Ziyād ٱ takes her back

Young men of Ḥaḍramawt and al-Sakūn tied up Ḥāritha and his companions, and took the camel back.

11 AH

Two great camps face each other

Banū Mu‘āwiya for Ḥāritha, Ḥaḍramawt and al-Sakūn for Ziyād[ؓ] ; Kinda held back, their men being prisoners.

Two demands, two refusals

Ziyād ٱ told them to put down their weapons; they refused and demanded their men; he refused.

11 AH

A strike by night

Ziyād ٱ hit them in the dark, and they scattered.

11 AH

The freed men rouse Kinda

Ziyād ٱ let Ḥāritha and the others go; they roused their people, and a large force called: no ṣadaqa.

11 AH

Al-Ḥuṣayn b. Numayr steps between

He was sent between the two sides, and for a little while they held off.

11 AH

Banū Mu‘āwiya withhold the ṣadaqa

The whole clan agreed, and each chief took up his own reserved pasture as a stronghold.

11 AH

Except one man and his son

Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simṭ and his son would not go with their clan.

11 AH

They tell their clan why

Before leaving, the two men told Banū Mu‘āwiya why they would not come.

Free men do not change sides

إِنَّهُ لَقَبِيحٌ بِالْأَحْرَارِ التَّنَقُّلُ، إِنَّ الْكِرَامَ لَيَلْزِمُونَ الشُّبُهَةَ فَيَتَكَرَّمُونَ أَنْ يَنْتَقِلُوا إِلَى
أَوْضَحَ مِنْهَا مَخَافَةَ الْعَارِ، فَكَيْفَ الْإِنْتِقَالُ مِنَ الْأَمْرِ الْحَسَنِ الْجَمِيلِ وَالْحَقِّ إِلَى
الْبَاطِلِ وَالْقَبِيحِ!

"It is an ugly thing in free men to change sides..."

11 AH

They move to Ziyād's ^{رضي} camp

Father and son moved out, and camped with Ziyād^{رضي} .

11 AH

Their advice: strike tonight

Before the men drifting toward the rebels from al-Sakāsik, al-Sakūn and Ḥaḍramawt get there.

11 AH

The danger in waiting

If you wait, we are afraid people will drift away from us to them.

Round their fires

IMAGE GOES HERE

MAP STUDIO, not Gemini: open tools/mapstudio/scenes/s03-07-hadramawt-and-kindajson, export step(s) 2–4, place here.

Kinda
the four kings

al-Ash‘ath
rises

11 or 12 AH

Ziyād ٱ agrees to a night attack

They gathered in the dark and ringed the pastures.

11 or 12 AH

Round their fires

They found the men sitting round their fires.

11 or 12 AH

From five directions at once

Banū ‘Amr b. Mu‘āwiya, the strongest of Kinda with the numbers, were attacked from five sides.

11 or 12 AH

Round their fires

فَوَجَدُوهُمْ جُلُوسًا حَوْلَ نِيرَانِهِمْ، فَأَكْبُوا عَلَى بَنِي عَمْرِو بْنِ مُعَاوِيَةَ، وَفِيهِمُ الْعَدَدُ
وَالشُّوْكَةُ - مِنْ خَمْسَةِ أَوْجُهُ

*"They found them sitting round their fires, and fell on Banū
‘Amr b. Mu‘āwiya — who had the numbers and the strength —
from...*

11 or 12 AH

The four kings are killed

Four brothers, the chiefs of Banū ʿAmr: Mikhwaṣ, Mishraḥ, Jamad and Abḍaʿa.

11 or 12 AH

Four, or four and a sister

Ibn al-Athīr adds their sister, al-‘Amarrada; al-Dhahabī, from Ibn Ishāq, names four kings and no sister.

11 or 12 AH

Many killed, the rest run

Many others were killed that night; whoever could run, ran.

11 or 12 AH

Home with the captives

Ziyād ٱ turned back with the property and the captives,
and his road passed al-Ash‘ath b. Qays.

11 or 12 AH

Al-Ash'ath rises

He rose with his people, took the captives back, and began to gather every man he could.

The march on Kinda

IMAGE GOES HERE

MAP STUDIO, not Gemini: open tools/mapstudio/scenes/s03-07-hadramawt-and-kindajson, export step(s) 5–6, place here.

al-Muhājir
ahead, from Ṣan‘ā’

‘Ikrima
the main body, behind him

11 or 12 AH

A letter: hurry

Ziyād ٱ wrote to al-Muhājirٱ , and the letter met him on the road.

11 or 12 AH

Al-Muhājir ﷺ rides ahead

He handed the army to ‘Ikrima ﷺ and hurried on with the fastest men.

11 or 12 AH

The battle at Maḥjar al-Zurqān

Al-Muhājir ٱ joined Ziyād ٱ and marched on Kinda; they met, and Kinda broke and ran.

11 or 12 AH

A fort already repaired

Kinda took refuge in the fort of al-Nujayr, which they had already repaired and put in order.

11 or 12 AH

The ring closes

The Muslims camped round it; ‘Ikrima ^{رضي الله عنه} came up with the main body, and the siege tightened.

11 or 12 AH

Raids through the country

Raiding parties went out through the country after the rest.

11 or 12 AH

The garrison sallies out

They came out to fight, lost many men, and went back in.

11 or 12 AH

The fort they had already repaired

فَرَجَعُوا إِلَىٰ حِصْنِهِمْ، وَخَشَعَتْ نُفُوسُهُمْ وَخَافُوا الْقَتْلَ

"They went back into their fort; their spirits sank, and they feared death."

11 or 12 AH

Al-Ash'ath comes out with nine men

The leaders inside had begun to fear for their own lives.

11 or 12 AH

A guarantee in return for the gate

They asked Ziyād ٱ to guarantee them and their families,
in return for opening the gate.

11 or 12 AH

Write whatever you want

Ziyād ٱ agreed: write it, and bring it to me to seal.

11 or 12 AH

Jahdam and the knife

As al-Ash‘ath wrote, Jahdam leapt at him with a knife:
write me in, or I kill you.

11 or 12 AH

He forgets himself

Al-Ash‘ath wrote Jaḥdam in, and left his own name out.

The knife at the writing

وَنَسِيَ الْأَشْعَثُ أَنْ يَكْتُبَ نَفْسَهُ لِأَنَّ جَحْدَمًا وَثَبَ عَلَيْهِ بِسِكِّينٍ، فَقَالَ:
تَكْتُبُنِي أَوْ أَقْتُلُكَ؟ فَكَتَبَهُ وَنَسِيَ نَفْسَهُ

"Al-Ash 'ath forgot to write himself in, because Jaḥdam leapt at him with a knife and said: Will you write me in, or shall I..."

11 or 12 AH

The gate is opened

Every fighting man inside was killed.

11 or 12 AH

The document comes out

Everyone named in it was spared, and al-Ash'ath's own name was not there.

11 or 12 AH

Al-Muhājir ﷺ has him bound

He praised Allah that al-Ash‘ath's mouth had erred, and had him bound tight.

11 or 12 AH

Sent to Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه with the captives

Someone said: send him to Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه , who knows best the ruling on him.

11 or 12 AH

al-Nujayr: the name he forgot to write

فَأَجَارَ مَنْ فِي الْكِتَابِ، فَإِذَا الْأَشْعَثُ لَيْسَ مِنْهُمْ، فَقَالَ الْمُهَاجِرُ: الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ
الَّذِي خَطَّأَ فَأَكَ يَا أَشْعَثُ.

"Every man in the document was spared — and al-Ash‘ath was not among them. Al-Muhājir said: Praise be to Allah, who made your mouth..."

11 or 12 AH

Ibn al-Athīr gives a second telling

He does not leave it at one account. He writes: and it is said.

11 or 12 AH

No knife, and no forgetting

In this telling there is no knife at the writing, and no name left out.

11 or 12 AH

Al-Ash'ath comes down alone

When the siege became unbearable, he came down on his own to al-Muhājir ر and Ziyād ر .

11 or 12 AH

Safety until Abū Bakr ﷺ decides

He asked for his life and property to be safe, until Abū Bakr ﷺ could decide about him.

11 or 12 AH

The price: the fort

In exchange he would open al-Nujayr and hand over everyone inside. They accepted.

11 or 12 AH

The kings are brought down

The kings inside al-Nujayr were brought down and killed.

11 or 12 AH

Bound, and sent to Medina

Al-Ash'ath was bound and sent to Medina with the captives.

11 or 12 AH

The captive women of his tribe

In this telling, the captive women of his own tribe gave him a name.

To Medina

IMAGE GOES HERE

MAP STUDIO, not Gemini: open tools/mapstudio/scenes/s03-08-al-ashath-to-medina.json, export step(s) 1, place here.

al-Ash‘ath
bound, to Abū Bakrؓ

11–12 AH

Al-Ash‘ath before Abū Bakrؓ

Asked what he thought would be done with him, he said he did not know.

11–12 AH

Abū Bakr ٱ gives the answer

Then I will kill you.

11–12 AH

Al-Ash‘ath argues the law

I negotiated that peace for ten, he said, so my blood is not lawful.

11–12 AH

Abū Bakr answers on the law

The answer turned on the document, and on the moment it was sealed.

"What do you think I will do with you?"

قَالَ: إِنَّمَا وَجَبَ الصُّلْحُ بَعْدَ خَتْمِ الصَّحِيفَةِ عَلَى مَنْ فِيهَا، وَإِنَّمَا كُنْتَ قَبْلَ ذَلِكَ مُرَاوِضًا.

"He said: The peace became binding, once the document was sealed, only on those named in it; before that you were only negotiating."

11–12 AH

Fearing death, he stops arguing

Look for some good in me. Free me. Forgive my stumble.
Treat me as you treated others like me.

11–12 AH

Give me back my wife

He had asked for Abū Bakr's َ sister and delayed the wedding; then the Prophet ﷺ died, and he apostatised.

11–12 AH

The best man in my country

Do that, he said, and you will find me the best in my country for the religion of Allah.

11–12 AH

Abū Bakr ﷺ spares him

He spared al-Ash‘ath's life and gave him back his family.

11–12 AH

Al-Dhahabī's shorter version

We will kill you. Be gracious to me, and I accept Islam.
He did, and married his sister to him.

11–12 AH

Ten, or seventy

Ibn al-Athīr has the peace negotiated for ten; al-Dhahabī gives seventy. The books differ.

11–12 AH

Released, and married into the family

Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه showed him favour, loosed his bonds, and married his own sister to him.

11–12 AH

A sword in the camel market

He drew his sword, walked into the camel market of Medina, and began hamstringing every camel and bull he saw.

11–12 AH

Medina thinks he has turned again

The people shouted that he had apostatised again.

11-12 AH

He throws the sword down

Then he threw the sword down and explained himself.

The wedding feast in the camel market

وَاللّٰهُ مَا كَفَرْتُ؛ وَلَكِنَّ هَٰذَا الرَّجُلَ زَوَّجَنِي أُخْتَهُ؛ وَلَوْ كُنَّا فِي بِلَادِنَا لَكَانَتْ لَنَا

وَلِيْمَةٌ غَيْرُ هَٰذِهِ، يَا أَهْلَ الْمَدِيْنَةِ، انْحَرُّوا، وَكُلُّوا! وَيَا أَهْلَ الْإِبِلِ تَعَالَوْا خُذُوا

شَرَوَاهَا!

"By God, I have not disbelieved. This man has married his sister to me, and had we been in our own country we would...

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

Three men of this evening go north

Qays, ‘Amr ٱ and al-Ash‘ath ٱ are met again at the Yarmūk, al-Qādisiyya and Nahāwand.

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

Sent to call Rustam to Islam

Al-Ash‘ath ٱ and ‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib ٱ were among the men Sa‘d ٱ sent before al-Qādisiyya.

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

Qays commands the left wing

He fought at the Yarmūk, came east with reinforcements from Syria, and commanded the left at al-Qādisiyya.

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

An eye each at the Yarmūk

Qays and al-Ash‘ath ٱ each lost an eye at the Yarmūk.

Side by side at Nahāwand

Ibn Kathīr lists ‘Amr^{رضي الله عنه} , Qays and Ṭulayḥa ^{رضي الله عنه} among the leading men of the army.

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

What Jābir ؑ swore

Ibn Kathīr records that Jābir ؑ swore: we found no one at al-Qādisiyya wanting this world with the next.

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

Three men were suspected

They had suspected three men of wanting this world.

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

They looked into the three

And when they looked, they found nothing to match their honesty and their indifference to this world.

"We suspected three men"

ولقد اتهمنا ثلاثة نفر، فما رأينا كما هجمنا عليهم من أمانتهم وزهدهم:
طُليحة بن خويلد الأسدي، وعَمْرُو بن معدي كرب، وقيس بن المكشوح.

"We did suspect three men — and ... found nothing to match their trustworthiness and their abstinence..."

Who the three were

Ṭulayḥa^{رضي}, who had claimed prophethood; ‘Amr^{رضي}, who had followed al-Aswad; Qays, who had turned on the Abnā’.

al-Qādisiyya to Nahāwand

Two books on Qays

Ibn Kathīr says Qays left Islam; al-Dhahabī's notice of him, a commander known for courage, does not mention it.

after 12 AH

He steps back at a funeral

At a funeral, al-Ash‘ath ؓ stepped back and put Jarīr b. ‘Abd Allāh ؓ forward to lead the prayer.

after 12 AH

Somebody asks him why

He gave the reason in six words.

after 12 AH

This man did not apostatise, and I did

إِنَّ هَذَا لَمْ يَرْتَدَّ، وَإِنِّي ارْتَدَدْتُ.

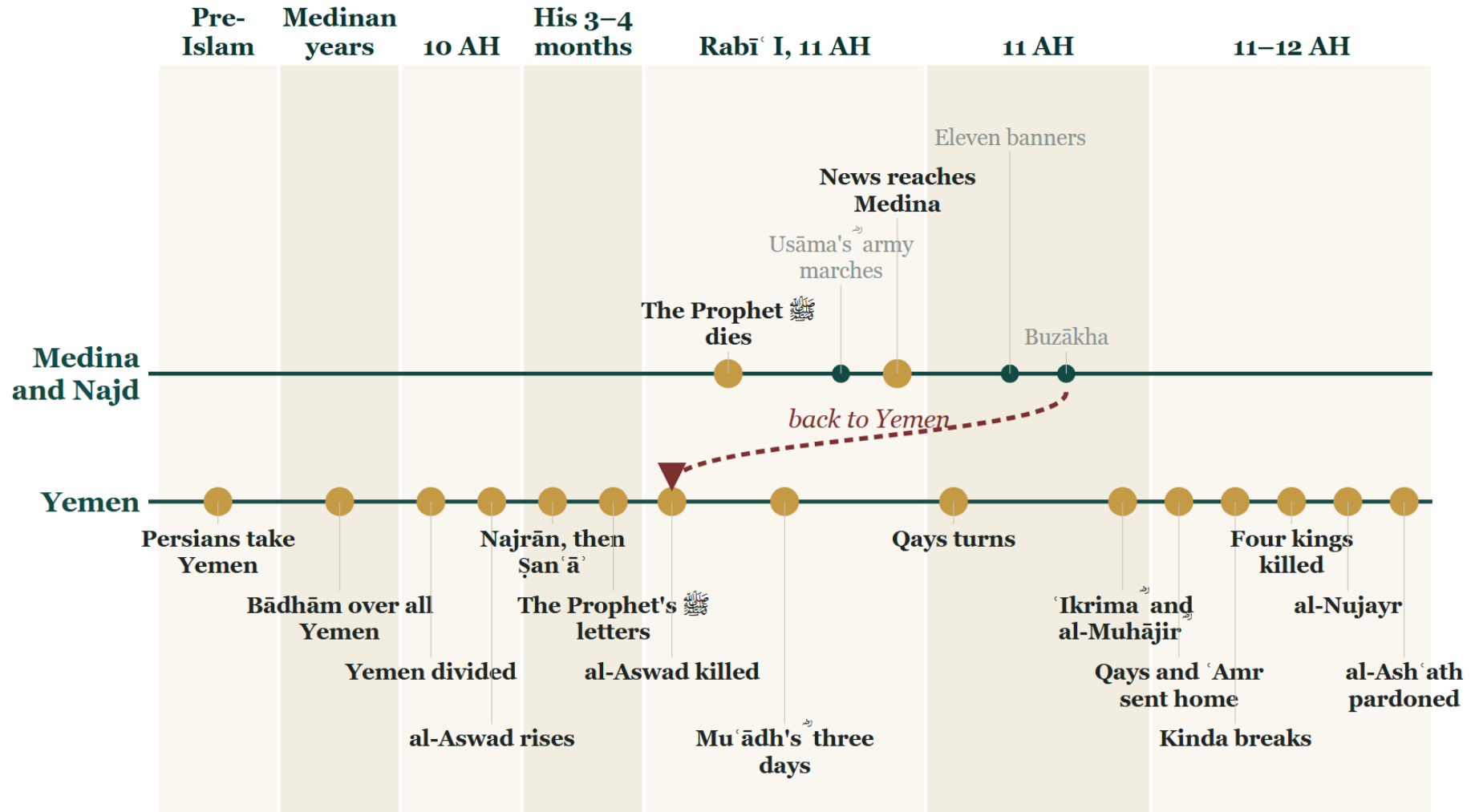
"This man did not apostatise. And I did."

after 12 AH

Said in public, years afterwards

Forgiven, married into al-Ṣiddīq's ﷺ family, made a commander, and he still said it of himself.

Tonight on the Line



Where we stand

IMAGE GOES HERE

MAP STUDIO, not Gemini: open tools/mapstudio/scenes/s03-close-stop-c.json, export step(s) all, place here.

The south
restored

al-Yamāma
where the story goes next

Tonight

- | The men came to her with half a plan; she was the one who finished the sentence.
- | A man who had just put down a rebellion had three quiet days, and then heard the news that undid them.
- | The state judged what it could see and left what it could not see to the One who sees it.
- | A man who will say the worst thing about himself out loud has taken its power away from everybody else.

Next week

Of the four claimants, two are still to be told: Musaylima in al-Yamāma, Sajāḥ from al-Jazīra. What became of them?